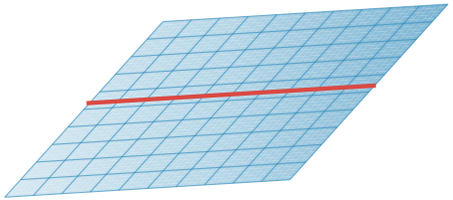
What can change in a fitness landscape?

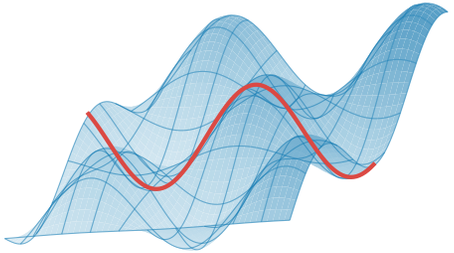
A conceptual view of landscape shape

(a) Additive slope



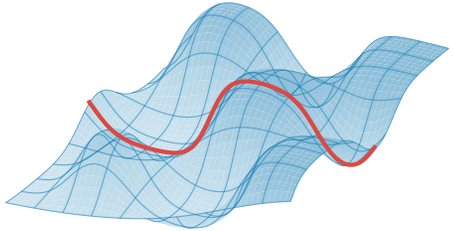
Effects add along a steady slope.

(b) Context dependence



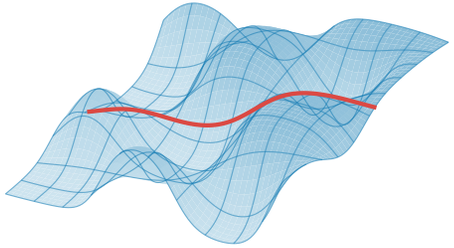
Interactions introduce peaks and valleys.

(c) Saturation



A monotone map compresses heights.

(d) Another surface



Unknown interactions change the shape.

Height is fitness

Same coordinate slice

Schematic surfaces. Horizontal coordinates do not encode sequence distance. Panels (b) and (c) retain the same peak locations.